educated so that they would be the ideal rulers. As Mason asserted, India needed British guardianship just as a child needs parents. [33]

Mason's books, originally written under the pseudonym Philip Woodruff while he still served in government, justified the notion of the 'White Man's Burden'.[34] They also made the argument that India would fall apart if the British were not governing the region. That, for people like Mason, the British should have continued to govern India is evident from the post-Partition epigram in his book: 'To the Peoples of India and Pakistan whose tranquility was our care, whose division is our failure and whose continuance in the family of nations to which we belong is our Memorial.' [35] Indian civil servants trained by the British carried some of these paternalist beliefs into their conduct long after the British left the subcontinent.

The humane justification for the empire notwithstanding, a majority of British civil and military officials saw India's importance in its location and its strategic importance for British security. Without India, Britain would only be a small European island nation with a population insufficiently large to defend and manage an empire extending across the world. The Indian Empire helped ensure British paramountcy from the Gulf to the Pacific. The Indian army was Curzon's cannon fodder to be used from Africa (Natal, Somaliland, Uganda, Rhodesia, Sudan and Egypt) to the Middle East (Aden) and Asia (Mauritius, Singapore, Hong Kong and Tibet).[36] Indian 'coolies', clerks and small traders were needed to exploit the resources in tropical climates where large numbers of British were unavailable, unwilling or unable to live. India enabled Britain to make up for its size, population and lack of natural resources.

Control of the seas was critical to Britain's colonial endeavour. British leaders as far back as Curzon were influenced by the ideas of Alfred Thayer Mahan, American naval strategist and historian, who emphasized the importance of sea power. Thus, in the eyes of the British, their security in